This is a level 3 Research Aid
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Groote Koninklijke Bazar

Abstract

The Groote Koninklijke Bazar (Big Royal Bazar) was a department store in The Hague. Dirk Boer, the owner of the company, started trading in Asian arts from 1825. In 1843, he opened his store at the Zeestraat.

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Description

The Groote Koninklijke Bazar was a department store for Asian wares in The Hague. Its owner Dirk Boer (1803-1877) began selling goods in 1825 and opened a store on Zeestraat in 1843. The store sold Asian items, mainly from Japan, China, Persia and the Ottoman Empire, as well as from the Dutch East Indies. The buyers were private individuals, including King Willem II, as well as museums, such as the Royal Cabinet of Curiosities and the then Rijks Ethnografisch Museum. After Boer's death, the business continued under new owners.

Provenance research

It is not known whether the business records of Groote Koninklijke Bazar have been preserved. Separate archive documents are held in various archives. The Municipal Archives of The Hague has some photographs of the store's interior showing many objects. The Wereldmuseum Leiden archive contains correspondence with Groote Koninklijke Bazar regarding purchases.

Related Aids

see also: Trade
see also: Royal Cabinet of Curiosities
see also: Wereldmuseum Leiden
see also: Kunsthandel Van Lier

Primary sources

Archive: NL-HaNA 2.09.46
https://www.nationaalarchief.nl/onderzoeken/archief/2.09.46/invnr/%40index
When public and later private limited companies were formed, their articles of association required approval by the Ministry of Justice. The content of the files could range from a single opinion to a pack of documents comprising articles of association, appeals, opinions, royal decrees and correspondence.

Archive: NL-HaNA 3.17.13.03
https://www.nationaalarchief.nl/onderzoeken/archief/3.17.13.03/invnr/%401
Documents from the Business Register (Chambers of Commerce) of the province of South Holland. Business name: Koninklijke Bazar voorheen D. Boer en Zonen NV, Groote. File number HA-000014 /1. Includes a set of commercial files.

Archive: NL-HlmNHA 476 811
https://hdl.handle.net/21.12102/567C414E21CB4FC48C35085331D8A768
Declarations of goods and services supplied, 1813, 1824-1831. The Royal Cabinet of Curiosities purchased items from Dirk Boer, which are mentioned in this archive.

Archive: Stadsarchief Rotterdam / Collectie Th. Haanebrink en Alex de Haas 4062
https://hdl.handle.net/21.12133/8F98F272DE4045309EA6FA218A2664FC
Poster of the Koninklijke Bazar from 1926.

Secondary sources

Article: Dam, Peter van. "The Royal Bazar of Dirk Boer: early Japonism in The Hague around 1840." Andon 7 no. 25 (1987): 16–19.
https://rkd.nl/library/89731
Article about Dirk Boer's store from the Journal of Japanese Art.

Article: Baird, Christina and Backx-Palsgraaf, Helen. "Viewing Japan and China through Dirk Boer's Panorama, 1835–1838." Journal of the History of Collections 32, Issue 1 (March 2020): 119–128.
https://doi.org/10.1093/jhc/fhy052
This article discusses Dirk Boer's activities that predate the Groote Koninklijke Bazar and highlights a Chinese/Japanese panorama as an illustration of the interest in China and Japan that existed in the Netherlands in the 1830s.

Book: Keblusek, Marika. Japansch Magazijn: Japanse kunst en cultuur in 19de-eeuws Den Haag. Leiden: Hotei, 2000.
https://search.worldcat.org/title/902181455?oclcNum=902181455, ISBN 9789074822251
Book about a previous store owned by Dirk Boer.

Book: Wap, J.J.F. De Koninklijke Bazar van den Heer D. Boer aan de Scheveningsche Zeestraat te 's Gravenhage. 's Gravenhage: Belinfante, 1854.
https://search.worldcat.org/title/67736999, WorldCat 67736999
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Catalogue: Boer, Dirk. Kabinet van Japansche, Chineesche en Oostersche zeldzaamheden, antiquiteiten en rariteiten ter bezigtiging opengesteld te Scheveningen: voorafgegaan van eene schets der zeden en gewoonten der Japanners, en gevolgd door eene beschrijving van dit Kabinet. 's Gravenhage, 1841.
https://search.worldcat.org/title/67826958, WorldCat 67826958
Description of the Royal Bazar by Dirk Boer.

Relevant Data

Identifiers:

https://www.wikidata.org/entity/Q13648189, https://hdl.handle.net/20.500.11840/

pi56363, https://rkd.nl/nl/explore/artists/349840 , Name variations:

Grand Bazar Royal, Dirk Aartsz. Boer, D. Boer & Zonen , Tags: Activity:

Art market , Type of objects:

Ethnographic objects, Ceramics, Tapestries , Geographical:

China, Indonesia, Iran, Japan, Oceania, Suriname, Turkey , Period of activity: Year of start: 1825, Year of end: 1927, Collections: Within the Data Hub: